

A PROJECT OF THE:



ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION

UNION PANAFRICAINNE DES ETUDIANTS

UNIÃO DOS ESTUDANTES DE TODA A ÁFRICA

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Report on **WORLD CLEAN-UP DAY**

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1.0 Foreword

In Ghana and across many parts of Africa, the effects of plastic waste are becoming more apparent. Streets, waterways, and coastlines are often choked with plastic debris, and many communities are left grappling with the devastating consequences of a waste management crisis. On the World Clean-Up Day, we are witnessing how grassroots efforts can make a profound difference. The day provided an opportunity not only to remove waste but to engage in meaningful conversations about sustainable alternatives, proper waste disposal, and the importance of reducing, reusing, and recycling.

The All-African Students Union (AASU), in our commitment to advancing environmental and climate action on the African continent, we are proud to be a supporting partner in this global initiative. World Clean-Up Day is more than just a day of action; it serves as an annual reminder of the power of collective action and the responsibility we share to protect our planet. It is an educational platform that not only raises awareness about the environmental impact of mismanaged waste but also inspires individuals, communities, and organizations to take practical steps toward a cleaner, healthier environment. This year's event once again underscored the urgent need to address the global waste crisis, particularly plastic pollution, which continues to harm our ecosystems, wildlife, and human health.

What stands out most from this year's World Clean-Up Day is the power of collaboration. AASU firmly believes that the road to a cleaner, more sustainable future for Africa is fighting climate change and waste pollution. AASU remains committed to the fight against climate change through environmental and climate action.

I sincerely thank Let's Do It Ghana, all our partners, and the vibrant volunteers who dedicated their time to make this year's World Clean-Up Day impactful.



Peter Kwasi Kodjie
Secretary-General
All-Africa Students Union (AASU)



2.0 Introduction



World Clean-Up Day 2024 was held on September 21st at Laboma Beach, Accra, with an assembly of passionate individuals and environmental organizations, united in their quest to create a cleaner and healthier world. Organized by Let's Do It Ghana, this year's event was supported by the All-Africa Students Union (AASU) alongside 34 sustainability organization. Notable partners including CMA CGM, Street Sense Organization, Zoomlion, DHL, Ecozoil, Ghana Wildlife Society, Bolt, Polytank, Jibu, LaDadeKotopon, Upcycle it Ghana, Ghana Wildlife, InfaniMedia, MyHealthCOP among others.

The scale of the waste crisis, particularly in urban and coastal areas, is undeniable. Plastic waste—often discarded irresponsibly—has become a ubiquitous threat to both human and environmental health. The unfortunate reality is that millions of tons of plastic waste end up in our oceans, landfills, and streets each year, contributing to habitat destruction, wildlife deaths, and long-term ecological degradation.

World Clean-Up Day 2024 at Laboma Beach provided a platform not only for action but also for education and reflection. This year's event sought to confront this crisis head-on by combining direct clean-up activities with wider efforts to promote waste segregation, recycling, and a deeper understanding of the environmental impact of our consumption habits. One of the most powerful aspects of World Clean-Up Day is the hands-on, grassroots approach to environmental action. Volunteers came together to clean up Laboma Beach and surrounding areas, directly addressing the issue of plastic pollution. Volunteers of all ages—from students to professionals—rolled up their sleeves and worked side by side to clear waste from the beach, removing harmful plastics and other debris that threaten local wildlife and marine life. It was a visual demonstration of how small individual actions, when multiplied by the collective effort of an engaged community, can lead to a tangible change in the environment.

The event aimed to address the environmental and social challenges posed by mismanaged waste, particularly plastic waste, through direct clean-up activities, recycling efforts, and awareness creation. The event also underscored the importance of community involvement in waste management, and its role in fostering environmental consciousness among participants.

3.0 Event Activities

3.1 Distribution of PPEs:

To ensure safety, all volunteers were provided with personal protective equipment, including gloves, reflectors, boots, and face masks. This measure underscored the organizers' commitment to the well-being of participants as they engaged in potentially hazardous waste collection. World Clean-Up Day 2024 was not only impactful in terms of environmental restoration but also in creating a positive and safe volunteer experience. These measures allowed for a productive, secure, and supportive environment where participants could focus on the task at hand, knowing their safety was a top priority.



3.2 Aerobics:



In the morning, the event kicked off with an energetic aerobics session at 9:00am to prepare volunteers for the physical demands of the day. This session, designed to get participants active and energized and set a positive tone for the clean-up ahead. Volunteers stretched and warmed up together, fostering a sense of community and teamwork before the clean-up began. The aerobics session not only ensured the physical readiness of participants but also contributed to the overall spirit of collaboration and enthusiasm that defined the days' activities.

3.3 Waste Collection and Sorting:

The clean-up focused on collecting waste along the beach, with a particular emphasis on segregating plastic waste from other types of waste. Volunteers worked diligently to sort the plastics, which highlighted the day's focus on recycling and reducing plastic pollution. As we continue to address the issue of plastic pollution, the clean-up at Laboma Beach serves as a powerful example of how individual actions—from recycling to waste segregation—can contribute to a global solution.



The involvement of volunteers, organizations, and partners throughout the day was a testament to the collective effort required to tackle this crisis. Together, we can create a world where plastics are managed responsibly, reducing their impact on the environment and building a cleaner, healthier future for all.

3.4 Refreshments and Health Services:

Participants were provided with drinking water by Jibu, as well as local drinks like Asana and Sobolo. Health check-ups were offered by My Health Cop Ghana, and First Love Massage provided massages to relieve participants' muscle strain, promoting a holistic approach to volunteer care. These well-rounded services emphasized a commitment to volunteer care that went beyond simply providing water or a quick snack

Bismark Amefianu Kudoafor and Belinda Mensah, the Chief Technical Officer and the Programmes Officer Environment and Climate Action working group respectfully delivered the solidarity speech on behalf of the Secretary-General, Mr. Peter Kwasi Kodjie of AASU. They shared AASU's commitment to advocating for equal opportunities for African Students and the numerous projects and programs organized to advance girls involvement in TVET. They reaffirmed their commitment to the cause.



3.5 Exhibitions and Sports:

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4.0 Outcome and Impact

The World Clean-Up Day 2024 left a lasting impact on participants and the community, with notable outcomes including:

- 01 Enhanced Environmental Awareness:** The event educated the community on the importance of waste management and the dangers of plastic pollution. Volunteers and attendees alike gained valuable insights into the role of individual responsibility in environmental conservation.
- 02 Strengthened Partnerships:** Through the collaboration with organizations such as CMA CGM, Zoomlion, and Ecozoil, World Clean-Up Day demonstrated the power of public-private partnerships in addressing environmental issues. This alliance paved the way for future collaborative environmental initiatives.
- 03 Visible Environmental Improvement:** Laboma Beach saw a significant reduction in litter, enhancing its aesthetic appeal and making it safer for marine life. The successful separation of plastic waste also contributed to the recycling process, reducing landfill contributions.
- 04 Community Engagement and Well-being:** The inclusion of health services, refreshment provisions, and entertainment contributed to a positive volunteer experience, encouraging greater participation in future environmental events.

5.0 Suggestions for Future Programs

To amplify the impact of subsequent World Clean-Up Day events, the following recommendations are proposed:

- 01 Broader Community Outreach:** Increasing engagement with schools, local businesses, and community groups could help broaden the impact of clean-up activities. This would foster a culture of environmental stewardship within the broader community.
- 02 Extended Waste Management Initiatives:** Introducing waste management education workshops and recycling drives in local communities could build on the lessons from World Clean-Up Day, creating long-term environmental benefits.
- 03 Increased Waste Collection and Sorting Efficiency:** Future events could implement additional sorting stations and provide training on waste segregation to volunteers before the clean-up to improve the efficiency and effectiveness of waste management efforts.
- 04 Enhanced Health and Safety Measures:** While PPEs were provided, future events could also include training sessions on safe waste collection practices to further ensure the safety of all participants.

- 05 Promotion of Circular Economy Products:** Expanding exhibitions of upcycled items can inspire more individuals and businesses to consider sustainable practices and circular economy initiatives.



6.0 Conclusion

World Clean-Up Day 2024 at Laboma Beach was a testament to the power of collective action and the vital role of community engagement in environmental conservation. The collaboration between local and international organizations, community members, and dedicated volunteers fostered a sense of shared responsibility for environmental protection.

The success of this event lies in the strengthened commitment of all partners to uphold a cleaner, more sustainable environment. As we look forward to future events, we remain optimistic that our continued efforts will foster a greener Ghana and a more environmentally conscious continent.

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